

Nicolas Eschenbaum

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Zürich, Switzerland

Economist and competition expert in industrial organization and competition policy, with a focus on algorithmic pricing, digital markets, and AI. I regularly prepare expert reports and provide economic analysis in competition cases and regulatory proceedings, and lead applied and academic research combining game theory, empirical methods, and machine learning.

Positions

- 2022–present **AI Lead and Managing Economist (Partner)**, Swiss Economics
Leading work on AI, digital markets, and competition policy in client and research projects. Member of the executive board.
- 2025–present **Member, Working Group AI/Algorithms**, Academic Society for Competition Law (ASCOLA)
Interdisciplinary work on the legal and policy implications of AI and algorithmic systems in competition law.
- 2022–present **Collaborator**, Institute for Categorical Cybernetics
Research collaboration on formal and computational approaches to governance, digital systems, and market design.
- 2024–present **Affiliated Researcher**, Center for Market Design, University of Zurich
Research on AI and agent-based models, with applications to energy markets.
- 2024–2025 **Global Fellow**, European AI & Society Fund
Research on foundation models and competition policy.
- 2018–2024 **Lecturer**, University of St. Gallen
Teaching in industrial organization, digitalization, and competition policy.
- 2018–2022 **Postdoctoral Researcher**, University of St. Gallen
Research on algorithmic pricing and competition in digital markets, funded by SNSF grant “Pricing in a Digital World.”

Education

- 2013–2018 **Ph.D. in Economics and Finance**, University of St. Gallen
Summa cum laude. Dissertation: *Essays in Industrial Organization*. Supervisor: Prof. Stefan Bühler.
- 2011–2012 **M.Sc. in Economics**, University of Edinburgh
Graduated with honours.
- 2008–2011 **B.Sc. in Business and Economics**, Maastricht University

Research Visits

- 2020–2021 **Visiting Scholar**, Düsseldorf Institute for Competition Economics (DICE)
Invited by Prof. Justus Haucap.

Publications

Peer-reviewed articles

- Picht PG, Nenadic L, Barnes O, Kuster Y, **Eschenbaum N**. “Selective Confusion: An Empirical Analysis of the DMA’s Brussels Effect.” *World Competition*, forthcoming. [link](#)
- Greber N, **Eschenbaum N**, Szehr O. “Peer-to-Peer Electricity Platforms with Endogenous Prices: A Multi-Agent Neural Network Control Approach.” *Energy and AI*, 2026.
- Picht PG, Nenadic L, Barnes O, **Eschenbaum N**, Kuster Y. “DMA (Verw-)Irrungen: Was die territorialen Umsetzungsstrategien der Torwächter über den Digital Markets Act lehren.” *Schweizerische Zeitschrift für Wirtschafts- und Finanzmarktrecht (SZW)*, no. 4, 2025. [link](#)
- Picht PG, Nenadic L, Barnes O, **Eschenbaum N**, Kuster Y. “Schweizer DMA-Brussels-Effect? Wie Gatekeeper den DMA in der Schweiz (nicht) umsetzen.” *sic! Zeitschrift für Immaterialgüter-, Informations- und Wettbewerbsrecht*, 3–14, 2024. [link](#)
- Buehler S, **Eschenbaum N**. “Explaining Escalating Prices and Fines: A Unified Approach.” *Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization*, 171, 153–164, 2020. [link](#)

Working papers

- Eschenbaum N**. “Shared Bidding Algorithms and Competition: Evidence from Electricity Markets.” 2026. [link](#)
- Eschenbaum N**, Greber N. “Market Power and Platform Design in Decentralized Electricity Trading.” 2026. [link](#)
- Buehler S, **Eschenbaum N**, Lenhard S. “Dynamic Monopoly Pricing With Multiple Varieties: Trading Up.” 2025. [link](#)
- Buehler S, Epper T, **Eschenbaum N**, Koch R. “Dynamic Pricing in Bilateral Relationships: Experimental Evidence.” Working paper, 2025.
- Eschenbaum N**, Greber N. “Repeated Auctions with Speculators: Arbitrage Incentives and Forks in DAOs.” 2025. [link](#)
- Eschenbaum N**, Mellgren F, Zahn P. “Robust Algorithmic Collusion.” 2022 (presented at the NeurIPS PERLS workshop). [link](#)
- Eschenbaum N**, Liebert H. “Dealing with Uncertainty: The Value of Reputation in the Absence of Legal Institutions.” 2021. [link](#)
- Eschenbaum N**. “Estimating Geographic Market Size Nonparametrically: An Application to Grocery Retailing.” Working paper, 2018.

Grants and Prizes

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| 2024–2025 | The Market for Foundation Models. European AI & Society Fund – CHF 50,000 (PI). |
| 2024–2025 | DMA-effects in Switzerland. Mercator Foundation – CHF 30,000 (co-PI). |
| 2022–2025 | ChartEP: Charting Energy Platforms and Market Outcomes under Varying Policy Measures. Swiss Federal Office of Energy – CHF 281,215 (PI). |
| 2022 | Young Scholar Award. CRESSE – CHF 1,500. |

2021–2022	Computational Learning in Economic Games. Hasler Foundation – CHF 35,000 (co-PI).
2021–2022	The Competitive Effects of Pricing Software Systems. University of St. Gallen – CHF 51,555 (co-PI).
2018–2022	Pricing in a Digital World. Swiss National Science Foundation – CHF 500,000 (co-investigator), grant no. 178836.

Selected Applied and Policy Work

2025–present	Study on modern pricing methods, pricing algorithms, and risks of collusion, European Commission tender EC-COMP/2025/OP/0053.
2025–present	Regulatory impact assessment of intellectual property rules for AI systems.
2022–present	Competition proceedings involving information exchange and cartel allegations, including in the retail sector.
2024–2025	Market definition and competitive assessment for a major digital platform.
2024–2025	Bidding and coordination analysis in secondary reserve power markets.
2024–2025	Assessment of reserve power requirements in Switzerland and neighbouring countries.
2023–2025	Market-power analysis for energy trading platforms using multi-agent deep reinforcement learning.
2023–2024	Price-elasticity estimation in German wholesale and end-user energy markets, <i>Wirtschaftspolitik</i> Nr. 47, State Secretariat for Economic Affairs.
2023–2024	Incentive analysis and mechanism design for a Web3 platform.
2024	Game-theoretic and agent-based analysis of issuance-curve effects on staking behaviour.

Recent Talks and Presentations

2026	Panellist, “The Next Wave of Tech Enforcement: Global Trends in Regulating Platforms and Algorithms,” AIJA 13th Antitrust Annual Conference, Düsseldorf.
2026	“Market Power and Platform Design in Decentralized Electricity Trading,” EARIE Annual Conference, Mannheim.
2026	“Algorithmic Pricing in Practice and Collusion,” ASCOLA Annual Conference, London.
2026	Invited talk on the DMA’s impact for Switzerland, State Secretariat for Economic Affairs (SECO), Bern.
2026	“Economic perspectives on market power in AI markets,” ASCOLA Working Group on AI/Algorithms workshop.
2026	Invited guest lecture, course “Digitale Ökonomie” (Prof. R. Kesler), Düsseldorf Institute for Competition Economics (DICE).